

Aggie Reuse: Donor Behavior Analysis

Introduction:

The Aggie Reuse store at UC Davis has been the go-to thrift store for many students, staff, and community members alike. The resource has seen hundreds of items come and go from its store every month, with a large catalog of goods that is almost constantly updated. However, with so many people donating every day, it's difficult to keep track of statistics related to our donors, including reasons for donations, how often they visit Aggie Reuse, and the amount donated at once. This project aims to identify trends in donor behavior, motives for donations, and investigate the relationships between demographics, donation habits, and engagement. Understanding donation behavior helps Aggie Reuse improve outreach, analyze item intake, and gain insight into its donor community.

Survey:

The data collection for this project will be done through a survey. Whenever someone enters our storefront for a donation, the sales staff will hand a flyer with a QR code to our donors to complete. The online survey was created using Qualtrics, including questions about donation items, reasons for donations, demographics, and the use of Aggie Reuse. The survey will be open from the start to the end of Winter Quarter 2026 (~10 weeks). Questions will vary based on a variety of factors, requiring the donor to complete only the questions relevant based on previous completion and donation contents. The survey also includes optional demographic questions (gender, race, ethnicity). However, they are all voluntary and are not linked to any identifiable data. The full question list is available at the bottom of the page.

Questions of Interest:

- 1) What is the most common way donors hear about Aggie Reuse? (Barplot)
- 2) Is there an association between donor type(student, staff, community) and their motivations to donate? (Chi-square test)
- 3) Is there an association between item quality(new, light use, moderate use) and item category? (Chi-square test)
- 4) Is there a correlation between visits to Aggie Reuse and the number of items donated? (Spearman's Rank Correlation)
- 5) Is there a difference in student years and the number of items they donate? (ANOVA)

Deliverable:

After collecting our data, we will use Tableau to create a dashboard, including various exploratory data analysis graphs, and answer our 5 questions of interest. There will also be a written summary detailing complications with data collection, data cleaning decisions, and all discoveries made after conducting our analysis.

Survey Questions:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1m9vkN9SkHZtBPMPY8efXCscpj6w4uvhJbK0yItpwVGc/edit?usp=sharing>